Qn. Set Code - 8

4th Sem
MBA & Ph.D.

SPRING END SEMESTER EXAMINATION - 2025

4th Semester MBA & Ph.D. Coursework

LEADERSHIP FOR CORPORATE EXCELLENCE

(BM 60104)

(For 2023 Admitted batch & previous batches)

Time: 2 Hours **Full Marks: 40**

Answer any Five questions.
The figures in the margin indicate full marks.
Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable and all parts of a question should be answered at one place only.

1. **"Paying Attention Pays Off for Andra Rush"**

Paying attention has been the key for Andra Rush. As a nursing school graduate she was paying attention when other nurses complained about unfair treatment and decided she wanted to do something about it-so she enrolled in the University of Michigan's MBA program so she could do something about how employees were treated. As she completed her business courses and continued to work as a nurse, she was paying attention when a patient described his experience in the transport business. The business sounded intriguing, and so, with minimal experience and minimal resources, Rush took a risk and started her own trucking business. She scraped together the funds to buy three trucks by borrowing money from family and maxxing out her credit cards. She specialized in emergency shipping and accepted every job that came her way, even if it meant driving the trucks herself. She answered phones, balanced her books, and even repaired the trucks. She paid attention to her customers and made a point of exceeding their expectations regardless of the circumstances. When the terrorist attacks of September 11 shut down local bridges, Rush rented a barge to make sure a crucial shipment for DaimlerChrysler made it to its destination on time.

Rush continues to pay attention and credits her listening skills as a major reason for her success. Rush is distinct in the traditionally white male-dominated trucking industry-a woman and a minority (Rush is Native American) who credits her heritage and the "enormous strength" of her Mohawk grandmother for helping her prevail.

"It is entirely possible that my Native Spirit, communicated to me by my grandmother and my immediate family, have enabled me to overcome the isolation, historical prejudice, and business environment viewed as a barrier to Native-and woman-owned businesses. The willingness to listen, to understand first, and act directly and honestly with integrity is a lesson and code of conduct my elders have bequeathed to me. Being an entrepreneur has reinforced those lessons again and again."

Her Mohawk heritage is pervasive. Rush's company logo is a war staff with six feathers representing the Six Nations of the Iroquois: Mohawk, Onondaga, Oneida, Cayuga, Tuscarora, and Seneca. She believes in the power of a diverse workforce and as a result more than half of the 390 employees at Rush Trucking are women and half are minorities.

Rush keeps close tabs on her company and its employees. Though the company has grown from its humble three-truck beginning to a fleet of 1,700 trucks, Rush still takes time to ride along with drivers. She has provided educational programs like "The Reader's Edge," a literacy program, to improve the skills and lives of her employees. Rush is actively involved in several organizations that work to improve the position of minorities-she's on the boards of directors of the Michigan Minority Business Development Council, Minority Enterprise Development/Minority Business Development Agency, Minority Business Roundtable, and has served as president of the Native American Business Alliance.

(a) Rush believes in the power of a diverse workforce. Cite the advantages a diverse workforce can bring to the work place. [4]

(b) What contributed to Andra's success in the trucking business? [4]

2. (a) How might raising people's awareness and helping people look beyond self –interest lead to transforming an organization? [4]

(b) It is said embrace or demolish can erode a leader's effectiveness by lowering his or her credibility. Explain embrace or demolish and provide justification for the above. [4]

3. (a) The path-goal theory of leadership effectiveness specifies what the leader must do to achieve high productivity and morale in a given situation .Justify. [4]

(b) Why developing a reputation as a subject matter expert is considered as an essentially ethical and honest influence tactics? [4]

(a) Why Multifunctional managerial development is considered as an organization's intentional efforts to enhance the effectiveness of managers ? [4]

(b) What is a pet peeve technique? Sketch out a possible pet –peeve session in a HR department and cite measures taken to address the problem. [4]

5. (a) Supportive communication is based on congruence, not incongruence. Justify with proper substantiation. [4]

(b) Gathering multiple inputs to formulate successful business strategy took place at Cadillac division (General Motors Corporation).Explain. [4]

6. (a) Can pivotal life experiences lead to leadership development going forward in life? Explain with real life examples. [4]

(b) Do you consider "differentiation", as a business strategy formulated by leaders? Explain with proper substantiation. [4]

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